

Regular Meeting
October 2, 2017
School Committee Meeting
Community Media Studio
Medford High School

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke in the Community Media Center at Medford High School at 7:11 p.m. Those present were Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Skerry, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke and Superintendent Belson. Ms. Cugno was absent.

Ms. Van der Kloot introduced Medford High School student representative Justin Tseng who is joining the school committee tonight.

A moment of silence was held for the victims and their families of the horrific event in Las Vegas.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot that the minutes of September 18, 2017 be approved:

As amended by Ms. DiBenedetto:

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto that the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved:

Voted: That the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 Cugno

Ms. DiBenedetto questioned a few line item payments which Superintendent Belson explained.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Skerry that the Payrolls be approved:

Voted: That the Payrolls be approved

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 Cugno

Committee of the Whole Minutes 9/18/17

The reading of the minutes was waived.

Discussion:

Ms. Kreatz commented that she has been inquiring this week about the notation on transcripts regarding rank before merger. She has learned that no additional information

may be added to the transcript. Guidance Counselors may write a letter regarding the rank before the merger.

On the motion of Ms. Kreatz seconded by Mr. Skerry to invite the Director of the Vocational School to a meeting to get clarification

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Ms. DiBenedetto commented that in the minutes she had made a motion to have separate internal rankings and notations on the transcript made.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Mustone to have an emergency meeting if this can't be rectified

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

On the motion of Ms. Kreatz to get a report on the number of students in each shop and a list of coop jobs.

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Ms. Kreatz said that robotics/engineering are presently traditional classes. In 2019 it is scheduled to go on the cooperative plan. She would like to re-visit this to keep it a traditional class.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Kreatz the minutes were approved

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Community Participation

Three teachers representing the faculty of the McGlynn Middle School spoke to the committee regarding the Action Plan that was discussed at the last meeting. Their concern was that the action plan lacked their input. Mayor Burke thanked them for their comments and concerns. Superintendent Belson said that we respect the teachers of the McGlynn. He welcomes their input going forward. Committee members voiced their concerns with the matter stating that they were not aware the teachers were upset and uninformed. Citizens McKillop and Viglione also commented on the presentation.

Report on Credit for Life Grant

Director of Curriculum Bernadette Ricciardelli presented the report. Dr. Ricciardelli stated that the Medford Public School district is the recipient of a \$5,000 grant to develop and provide a *Credit for Life* credit and financial literacy fair for students. Funding for the

fair comes from the Massachusetts Division of Banks in partnership with the State Treasurer's Office. The grants are funded through the Division of Banks settlement stemming from alleged unlawful lending practices. Medford's *Credit for Life Fair* will be held on Friday, January 26, 2018. All grade 11 students at Medford High School, Medford Vocational Technical High School, and the Curtis-Tufts School will participate in the fair, and grade 12 students may voluntarily opt to participate in the fair. *Credit for Life Fairs* are designed to be a dynamic way for students to learn about making real-world decisions about saving, spending, and budgeting money based on a host of career choices and lifestyle decisions. This half-day interactive financial decision-making fair will provide an authentic learning activity in which students will engage in basic personal financial management scenarios. Each participant will choose a "profession" in advance of the fair day, and then will be provided a mock financial "profile" with an individualized budget sheet on the day of the fair specific to the chosen career. Students will "purchase" goods and services such as housing, transportation, insurance, and food, all while living within their monthly salaries. The students' goal for the day is to balance their budget. Our goal is to provide them a rich financial learning experience that will be beneficial to students as they embark on young adulthood. Members of the planning team include Lisa Evangelista, District Public Relations Specialist; Gail Treanor, Assistant Principal at MHS; and Bernadette Ricciardelli, Director of Curriculum and Instruction. We are currently in the planning stages and are actively seeking community partners including banks, realtors, insurance representatives, mortgage lenders, and other financial-related business entities. We have made many contacts and have received an overwhelmingly positive response to our efforts. Future updates will be shared with the Committee regarding the progress of the planning committee's work.

Discussion:

Mayor Burke said that any one of the members will sign on to help and participate. She thanked the Massachusetts Division of Banks for this grant. Ms. Kreatz said that this will teach students valuable life lessons.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to accept report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Game Change Anti-Violence Partnership Grant from the NE Patriots Foundation

Supervisor of PE Rachel Perry presented the report. Ms. Perry stated that The Medford Public Schools has received additional funding to expand the "Game Change" initiative sponsored by the NE Patriots Foundation. During the past two years we have trained two staff members in the "Game Change" curriculum; added the curriculum to our high school health classes; and trained our athletic captains and club leaders in this violence prevention initiative. Trained students become "mentors" in violence prevention (MVP). The additional funding this year will enable us to train more high school students as mentors of the MVP curriculum to middle school students. The expanded program will enable us to hold awareness sessions and to integrate the MVP program into our middle

school health classes. A captain's council will be created to sustain the program at both the high school and middle school levels. On Thursday, October 12th Medford will participate in the "Game Change Captains Leadership Summit" at Gillette Stadium. Our "captains" will meet and work with exemplary peers across the state who have implemented creative "Game Change" programming in their schools. We will be sending one faculty member and four students to the summit. Game Change Captains will rotate through workshop sessions to learn best practices for training their peers. The goal will be to increase the number of students who can serve as mentors and to sustain this process on a continuous basis.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto asked once trained what does the mentor do? Ms. Perry answered that we have an MVP club and train as many as we can so that they can eventually go to the middle schools. Ms. DiBenedetto asked how the other students know who is a trained mentor. Ms. Perry answered that they have special tee shirts. Ms. Mustone asked if someone needs help who do the mentors go to. Ms. Perry answered that the mentors will direct the individual to the appropriate adult.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to accept report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Community Preservation Act Initiative

Roberta Cameron presented the report. She stated that The Community Preservation Act was adopted by Medford voters on November 3, 2015. The act established a local dedicated fund financed by a voter approved property tax surcharge of 1.5% and matching funds from the statewide CPA Trust Fund. During the first year this fund generated \$1.2 million. Each year the CPA will produce an amount based upon property values and state contributions. This means that this CPA is not a one-time source of funding and can be looked at for both short and longer term projects. Funding from this source can be used to support local investment in open space, historic preservation, outdoor recreation, and community housing projects. A description of the CPA and how it will be administered is attached to this report cover page. The Superintendent recently met with Medford's CPA Commission Chairperson to discuss the act and how it might be accessed by the Medford Public Schools for eligible projects.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto asked if the monies could be used for school yards and/or play structures. Ms. Cameron answered that the projects need to be balanced and all requests will be reviewed. Ms. Van der Kloot congratulated the committee and said she would like to see creative spaces like they have in England. It would be a wonderful addition. Ms. Kreatz suggested beautifying the school grounds with perennials. Ms. Cameron explained the upcoming community forums designed to listen to the citizens. Ms. DiBenedetto asked how they will decide. Ms. Cameron explained the review process and said that final recommendations will go to the city council.

On the motion of Ms. Kreatz seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to accept report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Report on the Second Annual Health, Wellness and Fitness Fair

Superintendent Belson reported that on Thursday, September 28th the 2nd Annual Health, Wellness, and Fitness Fair was held at the Medford High School Gymnasium from 5 – 7 p.m. The event was hosted by Mayor Stephanie Burke, the City of Medford, and the Medford Athletic Department. It was coordinated by our Public Information Officer Lisa Evangelista. This year we had 54 vendors as opposed to 25 last year. The first fair was for city and school employees. This year it was opened to the public. This free event featured: samples of healthy snacks, health checks, nutrition tips, fitness opportunities and financial information on health care. The Medford Family Network hosted a Children's Learning Table. District Attorney Marion Ryan provided Fall Safety Information. The attached flyer will provide you with more information on the vendors. There was a significant amount of free literature and promotional items to inform community members. In addition "Blades" the Bruin Bear and "Pat Patriot" were in attendance to encourage kids to live a healthy lifestyle. Lots of pictures were taken, This is another terrific example of how our community comes together on important issues.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Mustone to accept report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Report on School Brains Training

Superintendent Belson presented the report. He stated that On Thursday, September 28th training was held for principals and their office designees on the use of School Brains for state reporting and school wide operations. Special Education and Human Resource personnel also had sessions in the afternoon. School Brains Vice President Steve Cotton and his staff led the sessions with participation from DESE Specialist Diane Monaco. These sessions were very important to sharpen our knowledge of the software and its capabilities. Also it contributed to our ability to file complex state reports and to better advise teachers and staff on how to optimize School Brains. We will continue to have periodic trainings to ensure that our knowledge and practice stays current and effective. School Brains employs a System Interoperability Framework (SIF) with the State. This SIF provides users with timely feedback on input and cross validation errors. This is a major enhancement over our previous software (IPass) and is now a required element by DESE. The multiple yearly reports required by DESE are tied to the state's accountability system and provide us with data for ongoing decision-making. Each of these reports must cross validate. This can be time consuming and complicated as both

students and staff change. In the future we must establish a more formal human resource and data management office and team.

Discussion:

Mr. Skerry offered a point of information stating that perhaps this needs a subcommittee meeting because parents want their concerns addressed. Also to explain class ranking and to correct the inequities.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to hold a Committee of the Whole meeting within 30 days to discuss School Brains and inclusionary field trips.

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Ms. DiBenedetto asked who did the reporting in the past. Superintendent Belson answered that once trained and the initial input is done it shouldn't be very complicated. We should not need additional staff. Human Resources has many aspects and much tracking is involved including licensure and FMLA. We need to bring the department into the modern age and do this with existing employees. Ms. DiBenedetto asked for a graph that shows the lay out of administration and staff.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to accept report and place on file.

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Report on Concussion Law and the Medford Experience

Superintendent Belson and Supervisor of Health Services Toni Vento presented the report. Superintendent Belson stated that this report is provided as national and local news on sports related head injuries of prominent athletes have received significant coverage and sparked considerable attention. Chapter 166 of the Acts of 2010 entitled "An Act Relative to Safety Regulations for School Athletes" was enacted to address concerns regarding head injuries and concussions in extracurricular activities. In 2011 the Massachusetts Department of Public Health promulgated regulations 105 CMR 201 to implement the act. A copy of the act is attached to this report. Health care professions typically describe a concussion as a "mild" brain injury. Usually, concussions are not life threatening. However, multiple concussions over time can create lifelong adverse impacts. Recognition and response to concussions when they first occur can help prevent permanent damage and even premature death. In 2011 the Medford School Committee adopted a "Concussion Policy" and a "Return to Play Protocol" that was developed by our medical and training staff and is consistent with recognized best practice. Both of these documents are attached to this report. We follow these protocols with all our teams. Sports injuries are inevitable when athletes compete with greater passion and physical contact. Good equipment, appropriate training, and professional response can reduce and limit injuries and their impact on the student athlete. We continuously work to prevent and minimize student athletic injuries. The impact of a student concussion

goes beyond the playing field. It can also have an impact on the student's ability to learn in the classroom. Our nursing staff is very sensitive to the effects of a concussion on student classroom performance. Adjustments are made with teachers when a student needs accommodations.

Discussion:

Mayor Burke asked for a breakdown of male/female athletes. Ms. Van der Kloot asked why the numbers are increasing. Ms. Vento answered that concussions are better identified now. Ms. Van der Kloot would like to trace fall to winter to see if the list has overlapping athletes. Ms. Vento said that every season students must register and fill out information on concussions, so if there is a history it is noted. Students with higher risks are watched closely. Mr. Skerry asked if there is a follow-up with these students after graduation. Ms. Vento answered no and with HIPPA getting information is difficult. Ms. Mustone asked if the parent doesn't write about a prior concussion on the registration form does someone else review it. Ms. Vento said that it is reviewed by the school nurse and school physician. Ms. DiBenedetto asked if there is any data on non-athletic students with concussions. Ms. Vento said that this is not required to be reported to the state but all students are referred to a doctor and are followed in the same way. Ms. DiBenedetto suggested keeping this data in the future.

Negotiations and Legal Matters

Superintendent Belson updated the committee on two matters; Tarablesi trial that begins tomorrow and he explained that the Attorney General ruled that the multi media advisory meeting should have been posted according the open meeting law. A list of advisory meeting are now posted online. No penalties were incurred.

Ms. Van der Kloot asked if it was one time? Mayor Burke answered that it was multiple times. Superintendent Belson said that they didn't realize it needed to be posted. Ms. Mustone asked if the media center could incorporate a Google calendar for the city/school so that we don't have conflicts. Superintendent Belson said maybe eventually but it is very hard to schedule everything.

New Business:

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Dale Velie. Mr. Velie was the father in law of former Director of Finance and Administration Patricia Velie.

A moment of silence was held.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to suspend the rules to discuss the upcoming MASS/MASC conference:

Superintendent Belson asked that the members review their schedules and report back at the next meeting, October 16th if they will be attending the conference.

On the motion of Cugno seconded by Ms. Mustone the meeting was adjourned at 8:50 p.m.

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 Cugno

Respectfully submitted:

Paulette Van der Kloot
Secretary

